

SLS Robuster — Handoff Guide

Operator & ownership documentation (non-technical)

Who this is for: anyone who needs to install, use, or hand off this Mac app — even if you have never seen it before and are not a programmer.

What this app does in one sentence: SLS Robuster helps staff set live YouTube stream titles and thumbnails (and optionally update the school website) during School of Leadership Studies class broadcasts.

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1. What is SLS Robuster?

SLS Robuster is a **desktop app for Mac**. You open it like any other app (Safari, Zoom, etc.). You do **not** need to install Python or write code to use it day to day.

It connects to:

Service	What Robuster uses it for
YouTube	Rename the live stream, upload a thumbnail, put the video in an archive playlist, show “is it live?” status
DreamClass (optional)	Show today’s class schedule so you can pick titles/instructors quickly
WordPress + SLS Live plugin (optional)	Push the live video ID to the school website when you hit Apply

The main job on broadcast day:

1. Pick class title, instructor, and date.
2. Preview the title and thumbnail.
3. Click **Apply to live stream**.
4. Robuster updates YouTube (and the website, if that is turned on).

2. Where to find it on GitHub

There are **two** GitHub places. They do different jobs.

A. Download the app (this is what most people need)

Public updates repo:

<https://github.com/mrcodeimator/SLS-Robuster-Updates>

- Anyone with the link can open it (no special GitHub login required for downloads).
- **Releases** page holds the Mac zip files (the actual installers).
- Current release (as of this guide): **v2.2.0**
- Direct Releases page:
<https://github.com/mrcodeimator/SLS-Robuster-Updates/releases>
- Example download for Apple Silicon Macs:
[SLS_ROBUSTER-macos-arm64.zip \(v2.2.0\)](#)

B. Source code (for developers / IT only)

Private source repo:

<https://github.com/mrcodeimator/SLS-ROBUSTER-V2>

- This is the programming project (code).
- It is **private** — you need GitHub access from the organization account that owns it.
- Day-to-day users should **not** need this. Install from the public Updates repo above.

If you want...	Go here
Install or update the Mac app	Public: SLS-Robuster-Updates → Releases
Change how the program is written	Private: SLS-ROBUSTER-V2

3. Install on a Mac (step by step)

You need a **Mac**. The packaged app is built for macOS (current public zip is for Apple Silicon / arm64).

Step 1 — Download

1. Open this page in a browser:
<https://github.com/mrcodeimator/SLS-Robuster-Updates/releases>
2. Open the newest release (for example **SLS Robuster 2.2.0**).
3. Under **Assets**, download the `.zip` file (name looks like `SLS_ROBUSTER-macos-arm64.zip`).

Step 2 — Unzip

1. Find the zip in your **Downloads** folder.
2. Double-click it. macOS will create a folder or an app named **SLS_ROBUSTER.app**.

Step 3 — Put it in Applications

1. Open **Finder**.
2. Open **Applications**.
3. Drag **SLS_ROBUSTER.app** into Applications.
(You can leave it in Downloads, but Applications is the usual place.)

Step 4 — Open it the first time (Gatekeeper)

The app is not Apple-notarized yet, so macOS may block a normal double-click the first time.

1. In Finder, go to **Applications**.
2. **Right-click** (or Control-click) **SLS_ROBUSTER**.
3. Choose **Open**.
4. In the warning dialog, click **Open** again.

After that, you can open it normally from Launchpad, Spotlight, or Applications.

Step 5 — Confirm it launched

You should see a dark window titled **SLS Robuster**, with a left sidebar and tabs such as **Retitle**, **Schedule**, and **Stream Info**.

4. First-time setup after install

Do these once per Mac (or after a wipe). Settings are remembered for that user account.

4.1 Sign in each YouTube channel

Robuster needs permission to change each channel's live stream.

1. Click **Settings** (gear / Settings in the sidebar).
2. Open the **Channels** tab.
3. Click a channel chip (for example **SLS Year 1**).
4. Click **Sign In / Re-auth**.

5. A browser window opens — sign in with the Google account that **owns or manages** that YouTube channel.
6. Approve access when Google asks.
7. Repeat for every channel you will use (Year 1, Year 2, Intern, etc.).

A ✓ on the channel means login is saved. A ✕ means you still need to sign in.

4.2 Check channel details (if someone asks)

For each channel you can set:

- **Display name** — label in the app
- **Channel ID** — YouTube channel ID (starts with UC...)
- **Playlist** — archive playlist (dropdown after you are signed in)
- **WordPress profile** — e.g. year1 / year2 if the website should update for that channel
- **Thumbnail template** — optional custom background image path

Click **Save Channel** when done.

4.3 DreamClass (class schedule) — optional but useful

Used by the **Schedule** tab.

1. Settings → **DreamClass** tab.
2. Enter the API key, school code, and tenant your organization uses.
3. Save.

If this is empty, Schedule will not load live class data; Retitle still works with manual dropdowns.

4.4 WordPress / school website — optional

Used so **Apply** can update the live embed on the website (SLS Live plugin).

1. Settings → **WordPress** tab.
2. Turn on **Enable WordPress push**.
3. Enter the site URL (example: https://yoursite.com — no trailing slash).
4. Enter the **secret key** that matches the WordPress plugin settings.
5. Click **Test Connection**, then **Save WordPress Settings**.

Each channel that should update the site needs a **WordPress profile** filled in under Channels.

4.5 General preferences (optional)

Settings → **General**:

- **Preview Mode** — practice without changing YouTube
- **Start in Preview Mode**

- **Launch at Login** — open Robuster when you log into the Mac
- **Keep window on top**
- **Check for Updates** — look for a newer app version

5. How the app works (tour by tour)

Left sidebar

Control	Meaning
Hamburger (≡)	Expand / collapse the sidebar
Live Status	Shows each channel you chose to watch; Live / not live
Checkboxes next to channels	Which channels to monitor for “Check if Live”
Check if Live	Repeatedly checks YouTube until monitored channels are live (then stops)
Preview	When on, Apply only <i>logs</i> what it would do — no real YouTube/WordPress changes
Settings	Channels, presets, DreamClass, WordPress, General

Top navigation

Main work areas:

1. **Retitle** — compose title + thumbnail and apply to live streams
2. **Schedule** — today's (or any day's) classes from DreamClass
3. **Stream Info** — scan for live broadcasts, copy links / embed codes

An **Activity Log** at the bottom shows what Robuster just did (successes and errors). You can collapse it.

Retitle (main daily screen)

Title composer

- Choose **class title**, **instructor**, and **date** from dropdowns (lists come from Presets).
- Robuster builds a title like: `Class Title | Instructor | Date`
- The **thumbnail preview** updates as you change fields.

Apply to — check which YouTube channels should receive the change (Year 1, Year 2, etc.).

Apply to live stream — for each selected channel, Robuster tries to:

1. Find the **active or testing** live broadcast on that channel.
2. **Rename** it to the composed title.

3. **Add** the video to that channel's archive **playlist** (if a playlist is set).
4. **Upload** the generated thumbnail.
5. If WordPress is enabled and the channel has a profile: **push** the video ID/title to the website.

If Preview is on, none of those changes happen — you only see messages in the Activity Log starting with `[Preview]` .

Schedule

- Shows a timeline (roughly 8 AM–5 PM) with classes from DreamClass.
- **Family Center** and **Chapel** appear in columns.
- Click the date to open a calendar and jump to another day.
- You can send a class into Retitle (pre-fill title/instructor) when that action is available on a class chip.

Stream Info

- **Scan** channels for an active broadcast.
- Shows **Video ID**, **Watch URL**, **Embed code**, **Title**, **Started** time.
- **Copy** buttons for quick paste into other tools.
- **Push to WordPress** on a card if that channel has a WordPress profile.
- **Recover Missed Streams** helps with streams that were missed earlier (secondary recovery tool).

Settings → Presets

Editable lists of class titles, instructors, and dates. These feed the Retitle dropdowns. Add or remove items as the semester changes.

Settings → Channels

Add / edit / remove channels, Sign In, playlists, WordPress profile, "Show in Monitor."

6. Typical day-of-class workflow

Use this as a checklist for operators.

1. Open **SLS_ROBUSTER** from Applications.
2. Confirm **Preview** is **off** when you want real updates (on only for practice).
3. In the sidebar, check the channels you care about; optionally click **Check if Live**.
4. Open **Retitle**.
5. Pick class title, instructor, and date (or prefill from **Schedule**).
6. Confirm the thumbnail preview looks right.
7. Under **Apply to**, check Year 1 / Year 2 / etc. as needed.
8. Click **Apply to live stream**.

9. Watch the **Activity Log** for "Retitled...", "Archived...", thumbnail, and WordPress messages.
10. Optionally open **Stream Info** → Scan to copy the watch URL or embed for someone else.

If something fails with "No token" → Settings → Channels → **Sign In / Re-auth** for that channel.

7. Where everything is saved

The app itself

What	Usual location
The program	/Applications/SLS_ROBUSTER.app (or wherever you dragged it)

Updating or replacing this app **does not** erase your settings or YouTube logins.

Your settings and logins (important)

All personal/org data for the Mac user lives here:

~/Library/Application Support/SLSRobuster/

In Finder:

1. Open Finder.
2. Menu **Go** → **Go to Folder...**
3. Paste: ~/Library/Application Support/SLSRobuster
4. Press Return.

File / item (examples)	What it is
<code>channels.json</code>	Your channel list (names, IDs, playlists, WordPress profiles, monitor flags)
<code>retitle_presets.json</code>	Class titles, instructors, dates used in dropdowns
<code>general_settings.json</code>	Preview-on-start, stay on top, launch at login preference, etc.
<code>dreamclass_settings.json</code>	DreamClass API key / school code / tenant
<code>wordpress_settings.json</code>	WordPress site URL, secret key, enable flag
<code>app_config.json</code>	App wiring (update URL, default client secret name, etc.)
<code>client_secret....json</code>	Google OAuth client file (copied from the app on first run)
<code>token-UC....pickle</code>	YouTube login for each channel (one file per channel ID)
<code>thumbnail_layout.json</code>	Where text sits on the thumbnail
<code>thumbnail_preview.jpg</code> / <code>thumbnail_apply.jpg</code>	Recent thumbnail images Robuster generated

Treat the `token-*.pickle` files and secret keys as sensitive. Do not email them or post them publicly. If you copy this folder to a new Mac, you may move settings — but YouTube may still ask you to sign in again.

Launch at Login (if enabled)

What	Location
Login helper	<code>~/Library/LaunchAgents/com.sls.robuster.plist</code>
Log file	<code>~/Library/Logs/SLSRobuster.log</code>

What is *not* in that folder

- The **source code** (only on GitHub / a developer machine).
- The **public zip** (only on the Updates GitHub Releases page until someone downloads it).

8. Getting newer versions

For normal users (easiest)

If you already have **v2.2.0** or later as a real `.app` :

1. Open Robuster.

2. Settings → **General** → **Check for Updates**, or use the update banner if it appears after launch.
3. If a newer version exists, confirm download/install and restart when asked.
4. macOS may ask for your password if the app lives in **Applications** — that is normal.

Your settings folder (`Application Support/SLSRobuster`) stays put.

First install of 2.2.0 (or any brand-new Mac)

Still: download zip from GitHub Releases → unzip → drag to Applications (section 3).

How updates are published (plain English)

```
Developers change code in private repo (SLS-ROBUSTER-V2)
↓
Someone builds a new Mac zip
↓
Zip is uploaded to public repo Releases (SLS-Robuster-Updates)
↓
version.json on that public repo is updated
↓
Installed apps see “update available” and can download the zip
```

A **pull request / merge on GitHub is not the same as a public update**. Until the zip and `version.json` are published on **SLS-Robuster-Updates**, people’s Macs will not get the new build.

9. Common problems

What you see	What to try
macOS says the app can't be opened	Right-click app → Open → Open again
"No token" / auth errors	Settings → Channels → Sign In / Re-auth
Apply does nothing useful	Turn Preview off; confirm a stream is live or in testing on YouTube Studio
Wrong channel updated	Check Apply to boxes on Retitle
Website didn't update	Settings → WordPress enabled? Channel has WordPress profile? Test Connection
Schedule empty	DreamClass settings filled in? Internet working?
"You're on the latest" but IT just shipped	Public <code>version.json</code> may not be updated yet — ask whoever publishes releases
Update download fails / 404	Zip must be on public SLS-Robuster-Updates, not only the private code repo
Need a clean start	Quit app; optionally delete <code>~/Library/Application Support/SLSRobuster/</code> (you will lose logins and settings)

10. For IT / developers (short)

Topic	Where
Build the <code>.app</code> and zip on a Mac	<code>docs/BUILD.md</code> in the private source repo
How in-app updates and the two repos work	<code>docs/UPDATES.md</code> in the private source repo
Version history	<code>CHANGELOG.txt</code> in the project root
Public install / updates	mrcodeiminator/SLS-Robuster-Updates
Private source	mrcodeiminator/SLS-ROBUSTER-V2

Important packaging note: Google OAuth `client_secret*.json` is required on the build machine and is bundled into the release zip so end users can Sign In. That file must **not** be committed to git. User tokens (`token-*.pickle`) are created only on each person's Mac after Sign In.

App bundle id: `com.sls.robuster`.

11. Quick reference card

Need	Answer
Download app	SLS-Robuster-Updates Releases
Source code	SLS-ROBUSTER-V2 (private)
Install	Unzip → drag SLS_ROBUSTER.app to Applications → Right-click → Open
Settings / logins live in	~/Library/Application Support/SLSRobuster/
Main daily action	Retitle → compose → Apply to live stream
Practice safely	Turn on Preview
Update later	Settings → General → Check for Updates (after 2.2.0)

*This handoff describes SLS Robuster as of version **2.2.0**. If the app's version badge (sidebar / Settings) shows a newer number, prefer that build's behavior and the latest notes on the Updates Releases page.*